Nicholas Emery-Xu

Ph.D. candidate
Department of Economics, University of California-Los Angeles

nicholasemeryxu.com niemery@ucla.edu
+1 ### ###-#### nicholasemery google scholar

Education

2021- Ph.D. candidate in Economics — University of California, Los Angeles

- *Primary field*: Industrial Organization
- *Secondary fields*: Economics of AI, Political Economy, Economic Theory
- *Committee*: John Asker (chair), Hugo Hopenhayn, Simon Board, Will Rafey
- *Affiliations*: MIT FutureTech (2021-present), Forethought Foundation (2022-2023)

2019-2021 Ph.D. student in Political Science — University of California, Los Angeles

2014-2018 B.A. in economics, Russian (*summa cum laude*, distinction in Russian) — University of Pennsylvania

Research

Job Market Paper

1. Nicholas Emery-Xu. "Firm in the clouds: Supplier market power and technology adoption in the cloud computing industry."

Publications

2. Tamay Besiroglu, Nicholas Emery-Xu, and Neil C. Thompson. "Economic impacts of AI-augmented R&D." *Research Policy* 53(7), 2024.

3. Nicholas Emery-Xu, Andrew Park, and Robert F. Trager. "Uncertainty, information, and risk in international technology races." *Journal of Conflict Resolution* 68(10), 2024.

Working Papers

4. Nicholas Emery-Xu. "Artificial intelligence, productivity, and the labor share."

5. R. Daniel Bressler, Nicholas Emery-Xu, Robert F. Trager, and Allan Dafoe. "The offense-defense balance and the costs of anarchy: Welfare is U-shaped under offensive advantage." **(Under review.)**

Works in Progress

6. Nicholas Emery-Xu and Neil C. Thompson. "Computing power, productivity, and misallocation."

7. Nicholas Emery-Xu and Neil C. Thompson. "The impact of Moore's law on productivity slowdown and the labor share." *(Under Census Bureau Project #2590.)*

Policy Writing

8. Nicholas Emery-Xu, Richard Jordan, and Robert F. Trager. "International governance of advancing artificial intelligence." *AI & Society* 40, 2025.

9. Yong-Yeol Ahn, Christophe Combemale, Hassan Khan, M. Granger Morgan, Neil Thompson, Michael Affare, Tamay Besiroglu, Soojung Chun, Nicholas Emery-Xu, Elizaveta Gonchar, Ian Helfrich, Eunji Kim, Harrison Leon, Jayson Lynch, and Katy Yu. "Integrated summary: Semiconductors." In *Securing America?s Future: A Framework for Critical Technology Assessment*, 2023.

Presentations, Conferences

2026 SOCAE (planned), INFORMS Annual Meeting (planned), SEA (planned), BSE Summer Forum Applied IO, IIOC Rising Stars, UCLA (IO Proseminar)
2025 MIT (FutureTech lab meeting), IHS Junior Fellows Conference, UCLA (IO Proseminar)
2024 University of Pennsylvania (Wharton AI & the Future of Work), MIT (FutureTech lab meeting), UCLA (IO Proseminar)
2023 USC (Southern California Graduate Conference in Applied Economics), UCLA (IO Proseminar), UCLA (Theory Proseminar)
2022 Politics of Emerging Technology Mini-Conference, Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory (Great Power Competition in the 21st Century)
2021 APSA, GovAI (Works in Progress series)

Teaching and Mentorship

2025 ECON 452: Empirical industrial organization (masters), UCLA, TA for Martin Hackmann
2023–2026 ECON 104: Data science for economists (undergraduate), UCLA, TA for Kim Boswell
2026 ECON 106S: Competitive strategy (undergraduate), UCLA, TA for Simon Board
2026 ECON 106G: Introduction to game theory (undergraduate), UCLA, TA for Daniel Clark
2025 ECON 106I: Organizational economics (undergraduate), UCLA, TA for Moritz Meyer-ter-vehn

Mentor: Jiya Barman (BA, UCLA), Nathan Sokolovsky (BA, UCLA), James Lester (BA, Cambridge University, 2023 Cambridge ERA:AI Summer Fellowship)

Research Assistance

2021–2022 RA for Robert F. Trager (UCLA, University of Oxford; "International strategic dynamics of risky technology races")
2019 RA for Philip Trammell (University of Oxford, "Economic Growth under Transformative AI")
2016–2020 RA for Mitchell A. Orenstein (University of Pennsylvania; *From Triumph to Crisis: Neoliberal Economic Reform in Postcommunist Countries*, *Taking Stock of Shock*)

Grants, Awards, and Fellowships

2026–2027	Dissertation Completion Fellowship	UCLA ($20,000+tuition/fees)
2026	Doctoral Travel Grant	UCLA ($ 1,000)
2025–2026	Humane Studies Fellowship	Institute for Humane Studies ($5,000)
2025–2026	Lewis L. Clarke Graduate Fellowship (x2)	UCLA ($ 3,131.40)
2021–2025	Career Development and Transition Funding (x4)	Coefficient Giving (∼ $32,000/yr + tuition/fees)
2025	Junior Fellow	Institute for Humane Studies
2024	Expense Support	Institute for Humane Studies ($4,000)
2022–2023	Global Priorities Fellowship	Global Priorities Institute (£10,000)
2022	Effective Altruism Funds (with Mahendra Prasad and Caroline Jeanmaire)	Centre for Effective Altruism ($ 16,487)
2021	Graduate Research Fellowship Honorable Mention	National Science Foundation
2021	Graduate Summer Research Mentorship	UCLA ($6,000)
2020–2021	Graduate Research Mentorship	UCLA ($20,000 + tuition/fees)
2020	Graduate Summer Research Mentorship	UCLA ($6,000)
2020	Future of Humanity Institute Summer Research Fellowship	University of Oxford (£750)

Professional Service

Organizer: Southern California Graduate Conference in Applied Economics (2025)
Reviewer: *Research Policy, International Studies Quarterly, Security Studies, Macroeconomic Dynamics, Southern California Graduate Conference in Applied Economics 2022*

Languages

Programming: R (`dplyr`, `tidyverse`, `ggplot2`, regex) (advanced), MATLAB (advanced), LaTeX(advanced), Python (basic), Wolfram Mathematica (intermediate)
Natural: English (native), Russian (professional working proficiency)

Additional Training

2025	Writing workshop	EconScribe
2025	Data Economy Summer School	Isaac Baley and Laura Veldkamp
2027	Certificate in Russian language	Herzen University

References

John Asker (Chair)
Professor of Economics
johnasker@econ.ucla.edu

Hugo Hopenhayn
Professor of Economics
hopen@econ.ucla.edu

Will Rafey
Assistant Professor of Economics
rafey@econ.ucla.edu